

Cyberbullying

Coupled with the rise of instant online communication is an increase in online bullying, but support from parents and teachers can really help with upsetting interactions.

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What is cyberbullying?

Threatening or embarrassing someone using internet-connected devices is called cyberbullying. This can happen in many forms, including sending threatening or unpleasant text messages, impersonating someone online in order to obtain information, posting personal information without someone's consent, setting up a poll about someone, passing on secrets, and threatening to make information public.

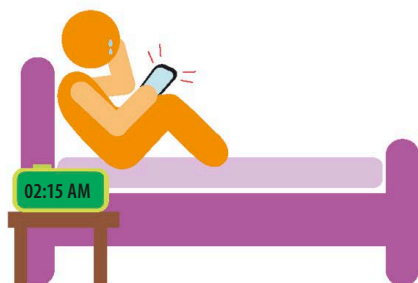
▷ How it feels to be a victim

Cyberbullying can make the victim feel scared and isolated. They may feel embarrassed and ashamed about what is being said about them, which can make it harder for them to ask for help.



What makes it different?

Unfortunately, bullying is fairly common in schools and among groups of young people, but cyberbullying has features that mark it out as different. Some of these make it easier to identify the bully and deal with the problem, but others make it much more difficult.



△ Any time

Cyberbullying can happen around the clock, even in the victim's home where, before internet and mobile devices, they would have been safe from this kind of abuse.



△ Anonymous

Cyberbullies have the ability to remain anonymous, and tracing the source can be extremely difficult, meaning that the victim doesn't know who to trust or blame.



△ Large audience

Cyberbullies can reach large audiences very quickly, increasing the victim's distress. Many people can become complicit by passing on a bullying image or remark.